CHAPTER 02 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

02

The argument in five moves

1 **The pilot is not the problem**
Successful pilots stall because the organisation around them cannot absorb them.

2 **Incoherence is the root cause**
Decisions wait, work keeps changing hands, priorities compete for the same people.

3 **AI amplifies what it finds**
Coherent enterprises compound value; fragmented ones compound confusion.

4 **Coherence can be designed**
Five properties, a fifteen-day diagnostic and five gates with named owners.

5 **Value is verified, not claimed**
Three horizons, five measurement rules and a 1.5× funding threshold.

> “Design for coherence first. Then amplify.
>
> THE SEQUENCE THE BOOK ARGUES FOR

The numbers that matter

3–8%
of revenue lost to incoherence — before anyone mentions AI
CHAPTER 3 · AUTHOR'S EXPERIENCE

30–40%
shorter cycle times in redesigned workflows
CHAPTER 9 · HORIZON TWO

1.5×
verified annual value before any structural funding
CHAPTER 9 · FUNDING RULE

15
working days from mandate to a board decision
CHAPTER 12 · FIRST CALENDAR

6–12
weeks average delay on major cross-functional decisions

15–30%
of a workflow's cost spent on rework and re-entry

150–200%
allocation of the scarce people every initiative needs

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- ✔ The enterprise already pays for incoherence; the question is whether it keeps paying.
- ✔ Every figure here is measured against a baseline, by Finance.
- ✔ The first decision takes fifteen working days, not a programme.